Speak out
3RD EDITION

B2+
PROGRESS TEST 4 | Version C

Part A • Grammar, Vocabulary and How to …

GRAMMAR

1 Put the words in brackets in the correct order to complete the sentences.

0 I **__bumped into Juan last__ (into / Juan / last / bumped)** Friday when I was at the shopping centre.

1 From _____ **(time / to / visit / time, / we)** my grandparents at their cottage in the country.

2 I must say they _____ **(happy / didn't / particularly / look)** to see us.

3 To _____ **(pleasure / found / I / out / my)** that I had won first prize in the short story competition.

4 We hadn't been horse riding before. Because _____ **(that, / of / booked / we)** a lesson.

5 Seeing _____ **(how / as / love / you)** sushi, I've bought some for dinner.

6 As _____ **(result / of / achieving / a)** such a good grade for the course, she had the fees refunded.

7 Disappointed _____ **(poor / the / by / turnout)** at last year's festival, they're not going to repeat it.

8 In _____ **(fact / the / view / of)** that neither of us can drive, we'll need to take the coach.

___ / 8

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2 Circle the correct words.

0 However / (**While**) there are plenty of green spaces in the city, there are few play areas for children.

1 Although / **At the same time** I sent her a message yesterday, I still haven't had a reply.

2 Admittedly / **Even though**, they've made some great songs, but this one is awful.

3 Ridiculous **as** / **that** it may sound, I promise you it's a true story.

4 Intelligent **that** / **though** he might be, he clearly lacks empathy.

5 There's no way I'll **be working** / **have worked** here in five years' time. I want to leave by the end of this year.

6 Do you think the shop will **close** / **have closed** yet? I wanted to buy some groceries.

7 He's going to be exhausted when he arrives because he'll **have been driven** / **have been driving** all night.

8 The shower might **have been fixing** / **have been fixed** by this weekend, but there's no guarantee.

___ / 8

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VOCABULARY

3 Circle the answer (A or B) that best completes each sentence.

0 Her latest poem ___ a real sense of sadness.

A specifies	B conveys

1 Let's ___ what we've talked about today before finishing the class.

A spell out	B sum up

2 When the government didn't meet their demands, the union ___ to strike action.

A transformed	B reverted

3 The band ___ onto the music scene in the 1970s with a number one hit.

A exploded	B evolved

4 The arrival of social media was a ___ for change in the country.

A surge	B catalyst

___ / 4

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4 Circle the correct words.

0 It's better to avoid food with too **much cholesterol** / **many nutrients** because it can be bad for your heart.

1 The strawberries were expensive as they were **in season** / **out of season**.

2 It's OK to eat **junk** / **organic** food every once in a while, but it's better not to eat it all the time.

3 Listening to that song **reminded** / **took** me back to my university days.

4 The show's producers were trying to **recreate** / **reminisce** the feeling of a long-lost era.

___ / 4

5 Complete the sentences with the words (A–G). There are TWO words you do not need.

0 You're not being followed. You're experiencing **_F_**.

1 My dream is for everyone to live in peace and ___.

2 Due to the ___, they were unable to leave their houses after dark.

3 If you put your luggage on the ___, it will be transported to the aeroplane.

4 I wish I could ___ to work every day so I didn't have to make the same boring journey.

A conveyor

B curfew

C greed

D harmony

E idealism

~~**F** paranoia~~

G teleport

___ / 4

6 Complete the sentences with words and phrases for science and technology.

0 The doctor attached a device so she could **m o n i t o r** my heart.

1 This machine uses the power of waves to **g _ n _ r _ _ e** electricity.

2 If you press this button, it will **a _ t _ _ a _ e** the fire alarm.

3 I've got a new **h _ n _ - _ e _ d** video console, which is small enough to fit in my bag.

4 Do you think this type of plastic is **r _ c _ _ _ a _ _ e**? I don't want to just throw it away.

___ / 4

HOW TO …

1 Circle the correct words.

0 We went to a (**classy**) / **shabby** restaurant for my birthday. It was expensive, but it was worth it for the experience.

1 After I left this morning, I realised I wasn't wearing **matching** / **vintage** socks. They were different colours.

2 It takes / **I've told you** a million times, I don't like watching any sports.

3 My feet are **killing** / **dying** me. I need to sit down for a while.

4 You'll literally be **nothing better** / **green with envy** once you've seen their new house. It's amazing!

5 If you **put aside** / **splash out** a little money every month, you'll soon save enough for a new pair of trainers.

6 I didn't buy the headphones because they were **discounted** / **overpriced**. I saw them for half that price in another shop.

7 I dare / **It seems** say you'll regret it if you leave your job now.

8 I guess that's **one side** / **one way** of looking at it, but I'm not sure I agree with you.

___ / 8

TOTAL: ___ / 40

x 1.25 = ___ / 50

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Part B • Listening and Reading

LISTENING

1 [Audio PT4.01] Listen to a speaker, Jasmine Patterson, talking about trends in education. Complete the sentences with a NUMBER, WORD or SHORT PHRASE.

0 People with experience in the education **____sector_____** should be aware of changes in educational practice.

1 Some people may find the expression 'grammar school' a bit _____.

2 The first grammar schools to be paid for by the government were established in the _____.

3 Some people were against the grammar school system because they thought it was _____.

4 It has been proven that SEL can help students increase their _____ at school.

5 Apart from pupils' social development, SEL is also concerned with their _____ development.

6 Some critics of SEL think it might cause young people to experience _____.

7 PBL is described as being a _____ way of teaching where students work on real-world problems.

8 In PBL, the way students work together and how good their projects are form the basis of _____.

___ / 8

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2 [Audio PT4.02] Listen to a radio discussion about innovations in the year 2050. Match each statement (1–4) with one of the innovations below.

- **Human-like robots [HR]**
- **Smart cities [SC]**
- **Space elevator [SE]**

The innovations may be used more than once.

0 A previously used idea will have been modified to improve the urban environment. **_SC_**

1 Something resembling this innovation's appeared in the media recently. ___

2 This innovation will result in financial savings in the future. ___

3 This concept is not likely to have been perfected by 2050. ___

4 We will be interacting with this innovation in our daily lives by 2050. ___

___ / 4

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3 [Audio PT4.02] Listen again. Are the statements True (T) or False (F)?

0 Felicity agrees with the **presenter** about **something** he **saw on television**. **_T_**

1 Felicity doubts that **human-like robots** will be **able** to **read** human **facial expressions**. ___

2 Felicity thinks smart cities designed in **consultation with local residents** will already have been **created by 2050**. ___

3 The **improved social conditions** in **smart cities** will **result** in **greater financial success**. ___

4 Scientists have made **no progress** in **overcoming issues related** to the **construction** of the **space elevator**. ___

___ / 4

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READING

4 Read four extracts in which people talk about changing eating habits. Are the statements True (T) or False (F)?

0 Phyllis explains that previous generations' attitudes to eating resulted from a limited availability of certain food types. **_T_**

1 Phyllis states that the only consequence of modern eating habits is lower quality diets. ___

2 Alberto suggests that young people are too lazy to cook meals. ___

3 Alberto believes the fast-food sector has led to more varied dining experiences. ___

4 Lois doubts that attitudes to eating led to a higher quality of life in certain countries. ___

5 Brett explains that some people went back to old cooking techniques because they thought microwave ovens were unsafe. ___

6 Brett points out that some well-known chefs are doubtful about the potential of microwave ovens. ___

___ / 6

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A – PHYLLIS

If I think back to the eating habits of my grandparents' generation, things **have changed a great deal. Lacking access to the wide range of** ingredients we have today, they needed to be frugal. Their tendency to eat **each meal at the same time every day would have avoided the need to** be constantly snacking as we do. For the younger generation, it's easy to **forget that binge eating is a relatively modern concept. We consume tea** and coffee whenever we feel like it and, due to the explosion in remote **working, many of us are grabbing snacks at random times during the** day. Not only has this contributed to poorer diets, but also led to more food **waste. Many of our half-eaten dishes and snacks end up in the bin,** generating an estimated 930 million tonnes of food waste globally each year.

B – ALBERTO

In the past few decades, eating out has become more popular in many **countries, especially among the younger generation. Their hectic** schedules don't permit them time to slave over a hot stove, which has **undoubtedly led to a decline in the ability to cook. The desire for a** more efficient experience has led to an explosion in the number of fast-food **chains in recent years with shorter waiting times and greater customer** turnover. The surge in demand for this type of restaurant has also been **driven by economic considerations, particularly amongst young people** who have seen wages rise very little. However, while they don't want to **spend a fortune on their food, neither do they want to compromise on** quality. As a result, some of the most exciting innovations have been in the **fast-food sector.**

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C – LOIS

The pressures of work and home life have changed people's attitudes **towards eating. Even in countries like Spain and Italy, where the whole** family would traditionally sit down to eat together at certain times of the day, **people's approach to mealtimes have become more flexible. This** recognition of the importance of regular meals, alongside high-quality **ingredients, contributed to a higher life expectancy. Some people worry** that the new approach of eating when you feel like it – also known as **'grazing' – is responsible for the surge in obesity and poor nutrition in** recent years. Nevertheless, evidence suggests that it may not be so simple. **While afternoon grazing may lead to negative health outcomes,** morning grazing seems to have the opposite effect so we should keep an **open mind on the consequences of changes in people's eating habits.**

D – BRETT

Microwave ovens were the food fad of the 1980s and revolutionised how **meals were prepared at home. They reduced cooking times by up to** 75 percent. However, concerns about food safety and quality soon emerged. **Some people wondered if it was a good idea to blast your food with** radiation or turn it into something resembling rubber. As a result, people **reverted to more traditional ways of cooking which led to more people** learning how to cook. In recent years, however, rising energy bills have seen **the microwave become popular again as the reduced cooking time** saves on electricity. Not only that, but the microwave has also gained support **from well-known chefs leading to this humble machine now being used** more creatively and with better results than ever before.

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5 Read the extracts again. For questions (1–3), choose the correct speaker (A, B, C or D).

Which speaker …

0 shares the same opinion as Phyllis that, in the past, people were more conscious of the need to keep a regular routine? **_C_**

1 takes the opposite view to Alberto on whether culinary skills have improved on the whole? ___

2 has a different opinion from Lois about the fact that modern eating habits may have led to improved nutritional standards? ___

3 has a similar view to Brett regarding the way financial concerns have caused consumers to experiment more with more economical ways of eating? ___

___ / 6

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6 Read an extract from a story. Tick [✓] the topics (1–4) that are mentioned and put a cross [x] beside those which are not.

0 The narrator's favourite type of weather. **x**

1 The reason why Lulu is no longer with the narrator. ___

2 The narrator's admiration for Lulu's attitude. ___

3 The narrator's frustration at the behaviour of consumers. ___

4 The narrator's intention to keep doing his job. ___

___ / 4

Making my way home at the end of another shift, the streets are silent **except for the inoffensive hum of delivery bots going about their** business. You'd be forgiven for thinking it's a winter's day, the sun struggling **to cut through the thick grey sky. In reality, it's the middle of July and** we're in the midst of yet another Bad Air Day. The pollution count is through **the roof and only those with a death wish would dare step outside.** Fortunately, my considerate employers have equipped me with a full face **mask. As I near my apartment, I pull the mask off and breath in the** filthy air, instantly breaking into a nasty hacking cough. How did we allow **ourselves to get into this situation?**

Entering the cramped apartment, I leave the face mask by the door, go into **the lounge and sink down into the sofa. I glimpse Lulu looking back at** me from her digital frame. She's smiling but there's a look of concern on her **face as if she's worried about the state of my life. Maybe she can't** understand why I took a job as a Jabber? Maybe if she were still here, I **wouldn't be doing it but I've got to pay the bills somehow and there** weren't many other opportunities apart from Omnium. Sure, Jabbers aren't **that popular with folk around here, but someone has to keep things** in order. If it weren't for us, who knows what would have happened by now?

Lulu was always the optimistic one in our relationship. I'd make fun of her **idealism, but deep down I had nothing but respect for her outlook on** life. She always saw the good in others, even when I couldn't. One time **some boys tried to steal her shopping on the intercity shuttle and the** Jabbers were onto them immediately. She refused to press charges, **insisting the Jabbers let the boys go as they were starving and didn't** know any better. She even gave them her shopping. Talk about an angel!

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What I could never accept was the way we let things spiral out of control. The environment was trashed, and crime and poverty had exploded. **Even if I wanted to, how could I have any compassion for my fellow** humans? We'd lost all common sense as soon as we got our hands on **those virtual PAs. We handed over access to our personal data, as well** as our bank accounts, to Omnium. We'd fought for years to restrict state **surveillance, but suddenly were allowing Omnium to carry it out in our** homes. Their cute little digiboxes monitoring and recording our every word **and gesture then using the information gathered to sell us more junk**. They turned us into consumer-slaves and we paid them for the privilege.

I'm not surprised things have got so bad, just amazed we've lasted this long. Omnium goods stream out of the factories day and night – supply never **falls behind demand. Yet no one stops to consider the true cost of all** this consumerism: unimaginable levels of air pollution, the indefensible **contamination of our water supply, and the disappearance of any hope** for the future. All I can do as a Jabber is ensure that no one interferes with **those delivery bots so their little wheels keep turning until the** inevitable day when everything grinds to a halt.

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7 Read the extract again. Circle the correct answer (A or B).

0 What does the narrator suggest in the first paragraph?

A The noise of the delivery bots is particularly annoying.	B The pollution poses a serious threat to people's health.

1 How does the narrator feel about being a Jabber?

A Pleased because it is what Lulu would have wanted.	B Resigned to the fact that he has few professional choices.

2 What does the narrator say about Lulu in the third paragraph?

A She showed more empathy towards others than he did.	B He found it hard to respect her attitude towards life.

3 What regret is implied by the narrator in the fourth paragraph?

A Not preventing Omnium from gathering information in people's homes.	B Relying too much on common sense to fight back against Omnium.

4 How does the writer feel about the situation he is in?

A He wants to change people's attitudes to Omnium.	B He presumes nothing can be done to change the world.

___ / 8

TOTAL: ___ / 40

x 1.25 = ___ / 50

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Part C • Speaking and Writing

SPEAKING

1 Describe and compare the pictures showing people using technology in the workplace.

How important to the jobs is the technology being used in these workplaces?





___ / 10

2 Answer your partner's question.

___ / 5

3 Listen to your partner talk about their pictures.

Ask: To what extent do trends affect the clothes the people are wearing?

___ / 5

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WRITING

4 Match (1–4) with (A–E) to complete the sentences from blog posts and opinion essays.

0 What drives me nuts **_D_**

1 The ice caps are at risk of **___**

2 It is sometimes necessary to **___**

3 How am I supposed to **___**

4 To me, it's just people **___**

A being lazy and not thinking about the environment.

B know why there aren't any cycle lanes?

C explain the dangers to people in simple language.

~~**D** is people that don't recycle their waste.~~

E melting forever if we do not act soon.

___ / 4

5 Read the essay question below and write your response.

'The rich are getting richer and the poor are getting poorer.'

To what extent do you agree with this opinion?

Write 200–260 words.

___ / 16

TOTAL: ___ / 40

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